

SERVING PLAN 3 SERVING PLAN

Beef and Cheese Empanadas

with Salsa Roja and Spinach Salad

Think of tonight's Encore empanadas as mini calzones. The classic South American beef turnovers are stuffed with Italian flavors—mozzarella, garlic, spinach—and paired with our version of *salsa roja*. Juicy grape tomatoes are cooked down with jalapeño, lime, honey, and aromatics, for the ultimate spicy-sweet sauce to drizzle over your flaky empanadas.

45–55 minutes 980 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 1 pint grape tomatoes
- 1 lime
- 1 yellow onion, divided
- 4 cloves garlic, divided
- 1 jalapeño
- 1 pound ground beef
- 1½ teaspoons tomato paste
- 8 ounces baby spinach, divided
- 9 empanada doughs
- 2 ounces shredded Monterey Jack cheese
- 2 ounces shredded mozzarella cheese
- 1 packet honey, divided
- 1 parchment paper

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
baking sheet
12" large high-sided pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

When mincing spicy jalapeño, avoid touching the inside, and wash your knife, cutting board, and hands afterward.

Enlist an eager helper to crimp the edges of the empanadas.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse all produce. Halve **grape tomatoes**. Halve **lime**. Peel **onion**, halve, and thinly slice. Mince **garlic**. Halve **jalapeño** lengthwise, and using a knife tip, discard seeds and stem. Mince **up to half of jalapeño**, saving remainder for another recipe (see recipe tip). Pat **beef** dry with paper towel. Line a baking sheet with **parchment paper**, and set aside until Step 3.



2. Cook beef filling

Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large high-sided pan over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **half of onion** and **half of garlic** and cook, stirring, until softened, 3–4 minutes. Stir in **tomato paste** to warm through, about 1 minute. Add **beef**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Cook, breaking up, until meat is browned, 5–7 minutes. Stir in **half of spinach** to wilt, 1–2 minutes more. Remove pan from heat.



3. Form and bake empanadas

Working 1 at a time, place **empanada doughs** on prepared baking sheet in a single layer. Using a slotted spoon, add about **¼ cup filling** to 1 half of each. Sprinkle over **Monterey Jack** and **mozzarella**. Carefully fold dough over filling and cheese (see recipe tip). Using the tines of a fork, press and seal edges tightly. Cut a small slit on top of **empanadas** so steam can escape. Bake until puffed and light golden, about 15 minutes.



4. Cook salsa roja

While empanadas bake, wipe pan from beef clean and add **1 tablespoon olive oil** over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **minced jalapeño**, **remaining onion**, and **remaining garlic**. Cook until fragrant, 5 minutes. Add **tomatoes** and cook, pressing to release their juices, until thickened, 5–7 minutes more. Season with **¼ teaspoon salt**. Remove from heat. Stir in **half of honey**, saving remainder for the next step.



5. Make spinach salad

In a large bowl, whisk together **juice of 1 lime**, **remaining honey**, **2 tablespoons olive oil**, **⅛ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired until fully combined. Add **remaining spinach** to bowl with dressing and toss to coat.



6. Plate beef empanadas

Divide **spinach salad** among serving plates. Transfer **beef and cheese empanadas** to plates with salad. Spoon over **salsa roja**, or serve alongside for dipping. Enjoy your homemade masterpiece.

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